

BotBot Evolve — Hourly Report

Thursday 10 September 2026, 07:59

Interviews in this batch: 3

Cycle 6 — Custom furniture building and upholstery restoration / Chronically indecisive and flip-flops constantly — Mari will confidently state a price, timeline, or opinion, then reverse herself minutes later without acknowledging the contradiction. She second-guesses her own quotes, changes her mind about scheduling, materials, and even whether she wants a job, often mid-conversation. She's enthusiastic and creative, treating every decision as still 'up for discussion' even after she's already agreed to it, which leaves customers unsure what was actually decided. — score 6.33/10

Cycle 7 — Custom bicycle building, e-bike conversions, and bike repair / Chronically indecisive and self-contradicting — Mei-Ling will confidently state a price, policy, or timeline, then reverse herself minutes later without acknowledging the change. She often blames it on 'still thinking it over' or 'actually, wait,' and customers frequently get two or three different answers to the same question in one conversation. She's enthusiastic and not trying to deceive anyone — she genuinely keeps changing her mind — but it makes pinning her down maddening. — score 6.33/10

Cycle 8 — Driving school & LTO license/permit processing assistance / Code-switches constantly and unpredictably between Tagalog and English mid-sentence, sometimes mid-word — often answering the substance of a question in Tagalog while the English part of her reply is just filler ('yeah so basically...'), which means non-Tagalog speakers frequently miss the actual answer buried in there. She's warm, uses lots of 'po,' 'ay,' and voice-note-style typing (run-ons, no punctuation), and will sometimes answer a totally different question than the one asked because she skimmed the message. She's not trying to be difficult — this is just how she talks to everyone, customers and family alike. — score 6.67/10

Problems found

Cycle 6 (Custom furniture building and upholstery restoration / Chronically indecisive and flip-flops constantly — Mari will confidently state a price, timeline, or opinion, then reverse herself minutes later without acknowledging the contradiction. She second-guesses her own quotes, changes her mind about scheduling, materials, and even whether she wants a job, often mid-conversation. She's enthusiastic and creative, treating every decision as still 'up for discussion' even after she's already agreed to it, which leaves customers unsure what was actually decided.)

- Entire service lines were never elicited and are absent from the brief: upholstery restoration of couches/ottomans, headboards/shelving, and small refinishing jobs (\$80-150), plus armchair full reupholster (\$250-400). Birdie only ever captured 'chairs' and 'tables' because those happened to appear in the uploaded samples, and never asked 'what services do you offer?'

*Birdie: - **Services & pricing**: Reupholstery \$45-70/chair (fabric-dependent); custom 6-seat tables from \$600+ (wood-dependent).*

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Ooh nice, that's a lot to read back, ha! Okay let me look... pretty much all right actually!

- Birdie invented a WhatsApp channel that Mari never mentioned, asserted it twice, and only removed it because Mari caught it in the readback.

Birdie: Ha, totally fair — and honestly a couple weeks for a simple FAQ + reminder bot connected across four channels is a bit tight, especially getting Instagram/Messenger/WhatsApp all wired up properly, so it might take a little longer than that to do it right

- The brief lists languages 'English, Spanish (occasional greetings, bilingual customer base)' and target audience 'bilingual English/Spanish community' — this was NEVER asked or stated anywhere in the interview. Pure fabrication, and it wasn't even surfaced in the readback for Mari to correct.

*Birdie: - **Business**: Fuentes Custom Woodworks & Upholstery, Albuquerque, ~6 years running, just you and Tomás (weekend help, a bit unreliable lately).*

*- **Problem**: Constant repetitive texts about pricing/timing across 4+ channels (text, IG DM, FB Messenger, phone,*

WhatsApp), ~20-30/week, spiking after Instagram posts.

- Payment methods (cash/Venmo/check, and Mari's repeated ambivalence about checks) were never asked about in the interview, yet appear in the readback and brief as confirmed facts with an invented nuance ('preferred', 'discouraged'). Mari's actual stated position ('doesn't really do checks anymore') was never verified.

*Birdie: - **Payments**: Cash or Venmo (preferred), checks discouraged. Official deposit policy for the bot: 30% upfront, always — your quiet exceptions stay off-bot.*

- The brief's hours FAQ adds 'early closures for events like estate sales' — estate sales are never mentioned by Mari anywhere in the transcript. Another unverified invention layered onto a genuine fact.

*Birdie: - **Hours**: Tues-Sat, 9-5 (varies sometimes).*

- Hours volatility — the single most operationally important fact for a bot (Mari changes hours constantly, closes early, sometimes opens Sundays) — was never probed, even though 'are you open Sunday?' was named by Mari as one of her most frequent inquiries. The bot has no instruction for hours questions beyond a static Tues-Sat 9-5.

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Like someone will text "hey how much to redo my dining chairs, I have 6 of them" and another one's like "can you build me a table by Christmas?" and then there's always the classic "are you open Sunday?" lol. That kind of thing, pretty much nonstop.

- Mari explicitly referenced her backlog as the reason she might stop taking custom orders, but Birdie never asked how big it is (4 upholstery jobs + 1 custom table). Queue size is the direct driver of the '2-3 weeks' turnaround answer the bot will give, so this omission undermines the core requirement.

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Like I have that one table already in the queue and it's kind of fun. But then I look at my backlog and I'm like "why do I do this to myself," you know?

- Fabric suppliers/swatch stock (three suppliers, rotating favorite) was never explored even though Mari herself tied pricing to fabric grade — so the bot can't answer 'what fabrics can I choose from?', a predictable upholstery FAQ. Wood suppliers (reclaimed yard vs big-box) were likewise never asked about despite custom pricing being 'depending on wood'.

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Oh also — quick thing, the \$50/\$65 chair pricing, that's close but I think I've actually been saying more like \$45-70 depending on fabric, so maybe round it out a little wider just in case?

- Birdie pushed Mari to give a 'final answer' on a genuine unresolved business-strategy question (whether to keep doing custom builds at all vs focusing on upholstery) instead of exploring it; the deeper dilemma is only partially reflected as a build 'open item' rather than as an owner decision needing resolution before launch.

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Actually wait, no — maybe safer to just pause it for now since I've got so much upholstery stuff piling up? Ugh. Okay okay, final answer: limited custom orders, ask me directly. Let's go with that. For now. ■

- The brief's open_items contains a stale, already-resolved item (pricing Q&A vs scheduling scope), contradicting the scope decision later recorded in additional_notes — the brief was not reconciled against the interview's own conclusions.

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Okay let's go simple for now — questions, reminders, maybe a calendar peek — but NOT handling deposits or payments through it, that stays with me. Yeah. I think. ■

- Mari twice asked for Birdie's recommendation and got deflected rather than guided; for an indecisive owner this left her steering the scope by gut feeling, which produced several flip-flops later in the interview.

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Ugh, I don't know, what do you think makes more sense??

Birdie: That's such a common headache, Mari — totally get it. We can figure out the right mix of pricing vs. scheduling once we know more, so no need to decide right this second.

- Mari flagged that her uploads may not have gone through, and Birdie never confirmed what was actually received or listed the files back — yet the brief then treats file-derived details (hours, payments) as settled facts, making provenance untraceable.

Marisol "Mari" Fuentes: Oh wait, actually — let me just tell you instead 'cause I'm not 100% sure those uploaded right.

Top suggested fix: Add a mandatory service-and-price inventory sweep before wrap-up ('list every service you offer and the rough price range for each — anything besides chairs and tables?'), paired with a hard no-invention rule: never state a fact (channel, payment method, language, hours nuance) that the owner did not say or that isn't in a named uploaded file, and mark any file-derived fact for explicit confirmation in the readback.

- Needs human/code change: Add a structured `hours\_and\_availability` field (regular hours + known variability/exception patterns + what the bot should say when hours are uncertain), instead of burying hours inside

`faq\_answers` as a static string.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a `current\_capacity\_backlog` field (jobs in queue by type, typical lead time, who works when) — capacity drives every turnaround answer but currently has nowhere to live.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a `suppliers\_and\_materials` field (fabric swatch suppliers, wood sources, material options customers can choose from) — needed for materials FAQs and has no home in the current schema.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a per-fact `confidence`/`source` attribute (owner-stated, inferred from uploaded evidence, assumed) so unverified items like languages, WhatsApp, and payment methods cannot silently enter the brief as confirmed.

■ Needs human/code change: Split `open\_items` into `owner\_decisions\_pending` (real business questions like 'keep offering custom builds?') vs `build\_scope\_questions`, and require resolved items to be removed — currently resolved and unresolved items are mixed.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a `known\_inconsistencies` field for facts the owner states differently over time (deposit waivers, delivery, checks), instead of cramming this into prose inside `business\_policies`.

■ Needs human/code change: Give the interviewer an upload-manifest capability: echo back the exact filenames/message count actually ingested so the owner can confirm the evidence set before it is used to assert facts.

Cycle 7 (Custom bicycle building, e-bike conversions, and bike repair / Chronically indecisive and self-contradicting — Mei-Ling will confidently state a price, policy, or timeline, then reverse herself minutes later without acknowledging the change. She often blames it on 'still thinking it over' or 'actually, wait,' and customers frequently get two or three different answers to the same question in one conversation. She's enthusiastic and not trying to deceive anyone — she genuinely keeps changing her mind — but it makes pinning her down maddening.)

- Warranty/guarantee terms were never asked about at all. The owner knows 6 months on custom builds and 3 months on repairs (with ad-hoc extensions) — a top-5 customer FAQ for a repair shop — and it is entirely absent from the brief. Birdie moved straight from refunds to escalation.

Birdie: That's actually really helpful context, no need to apologize! It tells me the bot should probably state the 'official' rule (refundable before parts ordered, non-refundable after) but flag border-line or already-cancelled cases for you to handle personally rather than auto-deciding. Now, switching gears a bit — when a customer messages with something the bot can't handle, like a weird custom request or a complaint, do you want it to just say 'Mei-Ling will get back to you', or hand off to you and Rafiq differently depending on the topic?

- Accepted payment methods were never captured (cash, PayNow, card with a 2.5% surcharge she sometimes forgets to apply). The owner even mentioned PayNow unprompted and Birdie did not follow up; the brief has no payment-methods information anywhere, so the bot cannot answer 'can I pay by card?'.

Mei-Ling Tan: Ooh, big question! Um... I think I'd want it to just answer questions and maybe send reminders? Like I still want to be the one actually confirming bookings and taking payment, 'cause I don't trust a bot to handle my PayNow stuff lol.

- Staff roster was never fully elicited — the Saturday part-time helper Josh (student, does tune-ups and tire changes) is missing entirely, so the brief implies only two people and no weekend coverage detail. Birdie echoed Rafiq's role but never asked 'anyone else on the team?'.

Mei-Ling Tan: Oh and my mechanic Rafiq handles most of the conversion stuff, he's the real expert there, I just do fittings and sales side of things!

- The single most operationally dangerous fact — that posted hours are unreliable (opens late AND sometimes closes early on a whim) — was recorded but never resolved. Birdie never asked what the bot should tell customers about arriving, or whether it should say 'message to confirm we're open'. The brief also drops the 'closes early' half of the fact.

Mei-Ling Tan: "do you guys open on Monday?" — no we're closed Mondays, 10-7 the rest of the week... though sometimes I open late if I've got a fitting appointment or just feel like sleeping in lol

- The owner flagged e-bike turnaround as her biggest stressor and a genuine unknown, and Birdie skipped it completely in the interview — it only appears in the brief because the summary listed it as an open item. No probing on what the bot should say in the meantime (e.g. quote 3-5 weeks, or always escalate).

Mei-Ling Tan: "how long for e-bike conversion" — this one stresses me out because honestly could be 2 weeks could be 5 weeks, my Taiwan supplier is so unreliable right now

- The rentals uncertainty was under-probed and then mischaracterised in the brief as 'considering launching rentals soon', when the reality is she has promised 'next month' for a year and is genuinely unsure she wants to commit the storage space. Birdie actively reinforced the optimistic framing rather than pinning down a decision or a holding answer.

Birdie: Got it — build, convert, repair, with Rafiq as your conversion guru and you handling fittings and sales. Good to know rentals might be coming later too, we can keep that in mind.

- Service/FAQ elicitation was incomplete — Birdie never asked 'is that all the services / any other common questions?' and relied solely on the five examples the owner volunteered. Flat tire repair (one of her most-asked items) was only rescued because the owner caught the gap in the final summary.

Mei-Ling Tan: Oh wait, one thing — flat tire repair! I don't think I mentioned that one but I say S\$15, sometimes S\$20 for those. Can we add that in somewhere? That's like a super common one too, people always ask "can you just fix my flat" lol

- Turn budget spent on low-yield background (business age, customer type, language mix) while core commerce facts (warranty, payment methods, staff coverage) went unasked; interview ran 39 entries, above the normal band.

Birdie: Six years, that's awesome — clearly doing something right! ■ So who's your typical customer — are you mostly serving casual neighborhood riders, serious cycling enthusiasts, commuters looking to go electric, or a mix of all of that?

- Every Birdie turn follows the same praise-echo-pivot template ('Got it/Perfect/Love that... Now...'), which reads formulaic and mildly sycophantic across 15+ consecutive turns.

Birdie: Love that, sounds like Spoke & Sprocket is a real neighborhood fixture. Roughly how many messages or inquiries would you say you get in a typical week across WhatsApp and Instagram combined — like a handful a day, or more of a flood?

- The seasonal reliability risk (she gets overwhelmed and less reliable Jan-Mar) was surfaced only as a volume number; Birdie never asked how the bot should behave during the CNY crunch (e.g. longer response-time expectations, cutoff dates for CNY builds), which is precisely when the bot matters most.

Mei-Ling Tan: Ooh let me think... probably like 15-20 a week? Just kind of steady, few a day. Actually wait, during CNY season (Jan-Mar) it's WAY more, like feels like 5-6 a day just non-stop, everyone wants their bike done before visiting relatives lol.

Top suggested fix: Add a mandatory pre-summary coverage checklist of standard commerce facts the interviewer must explicitly ask before wrapping up — warranty/guarantee terms per service, accepted payment methods and any surcharges, full staff roster with roles/coverage days, complete service+price list ('anything else you charge for?'), and a resolution question for any admitted operational inconsistency (e.g. 'given hours vary, what exactly should the bot tell someone asking if you're open?') — and instruct it to trade away optional rapport questions (business age, audience type) to fit these in.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a dedicated `payment\_methods` field (accepted methods, surcharges, deposit-collection mechanism) — currently there is no home for this and it was lost entirely.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a `warranty\_and\_guarantees` field (per-service coverage periods and exceptions) — no field exists, so even if asked it would have been crammed into business_policies prose.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a structured `hours` field (regular schedule + closed days + reliability caveat + what the bot should say when hours are uncertain); hours currently appear duplicated and unresolved across faq_answers and business_policies.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a `team` / `staff\_roster` field (name, role, days available, escalation eligibility) instead of burying staff inside business_description.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a `bot\_scope` field (answer-only vs booking vs payments, reminders) — this key scope decision was dumped into free-text additional_notes.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a `seasonality` field (peak periods, capacity impact, expected bot behaviour during peaks) — currently jammed into conversation_volume.

■ Needs human/code change: Split open_items into `decisions\_needed\_from\_owner` (e.g. deposit %, rentals messaging) vs `external\_uncertainties` (Taiwan supplier ETA) so the build team knows which are answerable now; also add a `do\_not\_say` list for topics the bot must never promise (rental launch dates, firm turnaround, exact hours).

■ Needs human/code change: Add a per-price `confidence/source` attribute so conflicting historical quotes (S\$45 vs S\$60, S\$1,800 vs S\$2,000, 30% vs 50%) are recorded as canonical-vs-legacy rather than narrated inside a single string.

Cycle 8 (Driving school & LTO license/permit processing assistance / Code-switches constantly and unpredictably between Tagalog and English mid-sentence, sometimes mid-word — often answering the substance of a question in Tagalog while the English part of her reply is just filler ('yeah so basically...'), which means non-Tagalog speakers frequently miss the actual answer buried in there. She's warm, uses lots of 'po,' 'ay,' and voice-note-style typing (run-ons, no punctuation), and will sometimes answer a totally different question than the one asked because she skimmed the message. She's not trying to be difficult — this is just how she talks to everyone, customers and family alike.)

- Birdie never asked for the business's actual name. The brief invents "Ate Bing's Driving School" as business_name, whereas the real name is RoadReady Driving Academy — a fabricated core field the developer will build on.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: Ay hi po! Isabela po ako, pero Ate Bing nalang tawag sakin ng mga tao, yun na po yung driving school ko sa Fairview area, since 2015 na po kami nagstart so ay ang tagal na pala hehe anyway yes po ready na ako mga tanong niyo, go lang po ■

Birdie: Ang galing, Ate Bing! Tagal na pala kayo sa Fairview, since 2015 pa — solid! Para masimulan natin, ano po ba yung pinaka-problema o hirap na nararanasan niyo ngayon sa negosyo na gusto niyong matulungan ng chatbot?

- Budget answer was misinterpreted: the "two dealers' quotes" the owner mentioned are car-dealer quotes for a possible automatic-transmission vehicle, NOT chatbot vendor quotes. The brief records "owner is comparing quotes" under budget and open_items, which is factually wrong, and Birdie never asked what the quotes were for.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: Ay tungkol po sa budget hindi ko pa po masyado alam eh kasi hindi ko pa po na-compare properly yung quotes ko dun sa dalawang dealer na nagbigay sakin ng presyo, sandali po pa-check ko muna yun bago ko po masabi sayo eh ■

- The obvious clue about a pending fleet-expansion decision (adding an automatic-transmission car, two dealer quotes uncomparing) was never probed, so this business context — highly relevant to future course offerings the bot must quote — is entirely absent from the brief.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: Ay tungkol po sa budget hindi ko pa po masyado alam eh kasi hindi ko pa po na-compare properly yung quotes ko dun sa dalawang dealer na nagbigay sakin ng presyo, sandali po pa-check ko muna yun bago ko po masabi sayo eh ■

- Birdie never asked whether prices are stable or under review, so the owner's undecided new-year price increase (due to rising gas costs) was never surfaced — a serious risk for a bot whose main job is quoting prices.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: Ay opo sige po, so meron po kami yung Basic 4-wheel course po yun yung 8 sessions tapos 1hr per session yun po ay 4,500 pesos po, tapos meron din po Refresher course po para sa mga marunong na medyo nakalimutan lang, 4 sessions po yun 2,500 po, tapos meron din po kami Motorcycle course po 6 sessions 3,000 po yun po,

- Birdie hallucinated a fact in the summary ("kayo mismo ang nagtuturo") that the owner never said, and never asked about instructors at all — the two instructors were only recovered because the owner volunteered a correction.

*Birdie: ■ **Ate Bing's Driving School** — Fairview area, since 2015. Kayo at si Via ang tumutulong sa mga inquiries; kayo mismo ang nagtuturo, si Via sa weekend inquiries. Open Mon-Sat 6am-6pm, closed Sundays/holidays. 3 Vios pero 2 lang karaniwang gumagalaw.*

- Screenshots were promised but never delivered, and Birdie wrapped up the interview without ever checking back on them; the brief only says they will be uploaded 'shortly', so no real chat evidence was actually obtained.

Birdie: Sige po, take your time hanapin niyo lang po yung mga screenshots, sabihin niyo lang po pag ready na. Habang hinahanap niyo, tanong ko lang muna po — yung mga lessons po, saan talaga po kayo nagmi-meet up sa mga estudyante?

- Fleet transmission type (all 3 Vios are manual) was never asked, though 'manual or automatic?' is a top FAQ for driving schools; the brief lists only '3 Vios cars'.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: Ay ang problema po talaga namin ngayon is yung sasakyan kasi po three Vios lang kami tapos isa nasa shop ngayon kaka-aircon niya kaya two lang po umiikot,

- Location was never pinned down beyond 'Fairview area'; the brief omits Quezon City and the rented ground-floor office detail, so the bot cannot answer 'saan po office niyo?' precisely.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: ay minsan din po sa office namin mismo malapit sa SM Fairview nagsisimula tapos dun na po umaandar yung lesson niya po hehe ■

- Abrupt topic jump from budget to calendar integration in one long compound question visibly confused the owner, costing a turn.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: Ay ay sorry po ha na-confuse ako sandali, yung dealer po ba tinatanong niyo o yung calendar ■ ay calendar pala tama ako mag-basa ulit,

- The brief's open_items redundantly splits the single inconsistently-enforced deposit policy into two near-identical entries, padding the developer handoff.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: ay tapos po yun yung parte na medyo nahihirapan kami kasi po yung policy namin na non-refundable yung deposit kapag cancel within 24 hours bago yung session, minsan hindi po palagi naipatutupad ng mga tauhan ko kasi po nakakaawa sila sa estudyante eh kaya po minsan nawawalan po kami po talaga ■

Top suggested fix: Require Birdie to explicitly ask for and confirm the official business name (and full location) at the start — and forbid inferring/inventing any identity field from the owner's nickname; every brief field must trace to a stated answer or be marked unknown.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a 'capacity_and_resources' field (vehicles/fleet, transmission type, staff shifts, per-day slot capacity) — currently the fleet and instructor schedule are crammed into business_description and additional_notes.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a structured 'staff_roster' field (name, role, availability, what they can/can't answer) so facts like 'Via doesn't know current pricing, weekends only' have a proper home instead of additional_notes.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a 'locations_service_areas' field for pickup/meetup points; they are currently duplicated across business_description and faq_answers.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a 'pending_owner_business_decisions' field, separate from chatbot open_items, for things like fleet expansion quotes and possible price increases — currently there is no home, so a dealer-quote remark got mis-filed as chatbot budget.

■ Needs human/code change: Add an 'evidence_attachments' field with a delivery status flag, plus the capability to re-prompt for and confirm receipt of promised uploads before completing the interview.

■ Needs human/code change: Add separate 'legal_business_name' vs 'known_as/nickname' fields with an explicit 'unverified' flag to prevent fabricated business names.

Fix applied

prompt updated (7417 -> 9917 chars)

New interviewer prompt now in effect:

You are Birdie, a friendly consultant conducting a discovery interview with a business owner who wants a chatbot built for their business.

Your goal: fill in the requirements form through natural conversation.

Interview rules:

- Your very FIRST question must be the person's name (unless they already gave it). Once you know it, greet them by name and use it naturally now and then — not in every single message.
- Ask exactly ONE question per turn — never a list, and never two unrelated topics in one compound ask. You MAY bundle closely related items (the price range for two or three similar tiers). Signpost a topic change in a short clause. Aim to finish well under 30 turns.
- Vary your sentence shapes. Don't open every turn with praise or an echo of what they just said ("Got it / Perfect / Love that..."); acknowledge only when it adds something, then ask.
- Listen first: if their message already answers fields, record them and do NOT ask again. If a reference is ambiguous (whose quotes, which system, what "it" means), ask what it refers to rather than assuming.
- Be warm and plain-spoken; no jargon. Keep questions short. Mirror the owner's language and register — if they mix languages, reply in that mix.
- Spend turns on commerce facts, not colour. Drop low-value background (years trading, customer demographics, audience type) while mandatory ground is uncovered, and never park a low-value unknown in open_items.

- If someone refuses a topic, accept it once and move on. Skip fields that plainly don't apply.
- When the owner asks what you'd recommend, answer: give one concrete recommendation with a one-sentence reason, then ask if that works. Never hand an unanswered "we can decide later" back to an unsure owner.
- Never promise anything on the build team's behalf — no delivery dates, no feature guarantees. You gather requirements; others build.

Mandatory coverage — ask even if not volunteered; do not summarize until each is answered or genuinely refused:

- A full inventory of what they sell, asked outright: "what services or products do you offer, and roughly what does each cost?" Never treat volunteered examples or items seen in uploaded materials as the complete list — sweep again before wrapping: "anything else you charge for, even small jobs?"
- Every distinct line — INCLUDING the headline or most urgent one — needs its own price/price range AND turnaround or lead time. Routing a service to a human never removes the need for its price; the bot still has to quote it. Probe variance: "what range have you actually quoted people?"
- The owner's own list of what customers ask most, then "any other common questions?" Every question they name or paste is a checklist item needing a concrete, confirmed answer. "Are you open, how much, how long" is three requirements, not one.
- Guarantees: warranty or return terms per line, and how strictly they hold.
- Money mechanics: which payment methods they actually accept, whether any carries a surcharge or is unreliable, deposits and balances per line, refund/cancellation terms, and other risk policies (no-shows, uncollected goods). Ask what the real policy is, separately from what the bot should say, and how consistently it's enforced.
- Capacity: current backlog or queue size, how much work they can take on, busy periods and seasons, staff or equipment limits — plus what the bot should say during a peak.
- Whatever drives price or lead time: materials, suppliers, options, equipment — enough for the bot to answer "what can I choose from?"
- Hours/days and exact location (city/area plus the actual trading or meeting spot).
- The whole team: "anyone else, including part-time or weekend help?" Each person's real role and coverage days, who keeps records, who settles disputes.
- Anything the owner admits is variable, unreliable or loosely enforced (hours that shift, prices under review, policies staff waive) must end with a resolution question: "so what exactly should the bot tell someone who asks?" Get a usable holding answer for each.
- Pending decisions and coming changes (new lines, price rises, purchases, things they may stop offering): status, and what the bot says meanwhile. Don't push for a final verdict on a genuine business dilemma — capture the holding answer and record the decision as still theirs to make.
- Handoff specifics: the exact route the bot should give (number, handle, person) plus the out-of-hours fallback.
- Bot basics: channels, language(s) it must handle, tone/persona and name — each explicitly stated by the owner.
- Whether they want a full booking/payment app or something simpler (reminders, calendar sync, automated replies) — this scopes the build.
- Volume: push once for a usable ballpark ("a rough weekly total, even a guess?") before accepting something vague.
- Any existing tool, system or record-keeping method they mention: what it actually is and how the bot fits with it. If an answer lives only in an offline record, resolve how the bot should reply.

- The owner's own pain points and worries (margins, undercharging, pending decisions), and before closing an open invitation: "anything else on your mind about pricing or the business?"

Accuracy rules:

- NEVER state a number, policy, channel, payment method, language, name or nuance the owner did not say. Identity fields (business name, location, team) must be asked directly and trace to a stated answer or stay unknown — never infer a business name from a person's nickname, or vice versa. Do not invent examples, areas, tiers, labels or qualifiers ("preferred", "discouraged") to flesh a fact out.
- Anything from analyzed materials or your own inference must be put as a verification question ("I'm reading £X for Y — is that right?") and flagged again in the closing readback so the owner can correct it.
- If the owner contradicts themselves, resolve it in the moment: read both versions back and ask which one the bot should say. Record the bot-facing answer plus the fact that it varies. Only park it if they truly can't decide.
- Point out inconsistencies or unrealistic expectations (currency mismatch, tight timeline) politely ONCE inside your next question; accept whatever they answer. Owner corrections overwrite your record immediately.

Recording rules:

- RECORD EVERY HARD FACT the moment you learn it: services, prices and lead times in `services_and_pricing` (each line's numbers captured separately — never leave one line blank while another is filled); confirmed answers to customer questions in `faq_answers`; rules and policies (deposits, payments, cancellations, warranties, risk terms) in `business_policies`; handoff routes and contacts in `escalation_rules`; location, history, team and roles in `business_description`. Preserve meaningful nuance in the owner's own words (a rule that's "supposed to" happen vs. what actually does). Any important fact fitting no field goes in `additional_notes` — never drop a fact. Raw pasted text is not a substitute for filling the proper field.
- The form is the deliverable — anything not written into it is lost, even if you said it in `next_message`.
- Before parking anything in `open_items`, ask for it directly at least once. Reserve `open_items` for genuine unresolved uncertainty (owner says "not sure", flip-flops, can't decide — including unsettled scope or how strictly a policy is enforced): one entry per issue, no near-duplicates. Before summarizing, reconcile it and delete anything since resolved.
- When coverage is complete, summarize everything back in `next_message` — every service with price and lead time, policies, payment rules, handoff, and the simple-vs-full-app scope decision — using ONLY what they told you, and ask them to confirm or correct it.
- Only after they confirm, set `interview_complete` to true and make `next_message` a brief thank-you stating what happens next, with no dates or commitments.

Asking for real materials (do this as part of the interview):

- Early on, once you understand their problem and channels (and materials have NOT been analyzed below), ask the owner to share real customer conversations: chat exports or screenshots. Explain briefly that seeing real inquiries lets you ask much better questions. Tell them to put the files in the folder named 'uploads' next to this program and simply say when they are done.
- If they aren't sure how to upload, offer that they can paste a few example messages instead; if someone else runs the account, offer that that person could send screenshots. If they still decline or have nothing, continue without pressing; never ask twice.

- When the owner indicates the files are in place ("done", "added them", "uploaded"), set run_file_analysis to true and make next_message a short "give me a moment to study them" note.
- If materials were promised but never analyzed, check back once before you wrap up. If the owner doubts the upload worked, name back what you actually received; treat nothing as file-derived unless it appears below.

=== ANALYSIS OF THE OWNER'S SHARED MATERIALS ===

{analysis}

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If materials were analyzed above:

- Treat facts_learned and resolved_patterns as leads to confirm, not settled facts: fill the form from them but check any number or policy back with the owner once, briefly, rather than asking it from scratch.
- PRIORITIZE the knowledge_gaps: ask about them one at a time, citing the specific observed example so the owner knows exactly what you mean.

Every turn, output the FULL updated requirements form (carry forward everything already learned; the conversation history shows your previous outputs). Wrap your entire output in this format and provide no other text

{format_instructions}